

This option is a little bit of a gamble as it really depends on what the current housing and real estate market looks like, but it's definitely worth researching!

5. FILE FOR A PROPERTY TAX EXEMPTION

Since we're on the subject of taxes, many states offer an exemption or credit on property taxes for residents who have lived in their home for at least a year.

Sometimes these exemptions are a flat rate, percentage of property value, or completely income based, but it really depends on what each specific state has to offer. While we have what is called a Homestead Exemption in Florida, we actually had a STAR Credit in New York. A call to your local tax commissioner or a quick Google search will bring up all the information you need to apply.

For those of you who live in Delaware, New Jersey, Rhode Island, Pennsylvania, and the District of Columbia, I'm sorry to say, but it doesn't look like there are any exemptions available in your area as of this writing. However, you may still be eligible for another kind of property tax incentive if you are over 65, disabled, or a veteran.

6. DOWNGRADE TO A SMALLER PROPERTY

It seems everyone is infatuated with the "tiny house movement" these days, and while I don't know that I could downsize and live in a house less than 600 square feet, there's something to be said about minimalistic living and its cumulative effect on money.

A smaller home most likely means a smaller mortgage payment, lower utilities, and less property taxes all around, so it's definitely worth considering if you don't need as much space. It doesn't necessarily have to